ZikShare

ACADEMIC VAULT

UNIZIK FRESHER EDITION | 2026

Google Workspace and Cloud Collaboration: Work Together Without Chaos

Shared documents, files and calendars that keep group assignments on track

DIGITAL SKILLS

Digital Skills

General Studies (GST / CED)
GST Directorate | 100L

Written for students, by students.

Practical notes, worked examples, practice questions and a revision plan.

Free to download. No fee, no payment step, no watermark.

Independent study support | Not an official UNIZIK publication

START HERE

Why this pack exists

Group work fails when files are scattered across WhatsApp and nobody knows which version is final. This pack explains shared drives, document permissions, comments and suggestions, version history and offline access, plus a simple group workflow.

This is a student-written study companion, not a reproduced lecture handout or a leaked examination paper. Use it to organise the topics you are taught, practise the kind of thinking your course rewards, and walk into class with better questions.

What you will be able to do

- Structure and share a Google Drive folder with correct permissions.
- Collaborate in Docs and Sheets using comments and suggestions.
- Recover earlier versions and avoid conflicting copies.
- Set up a group workflow with clear ownership and deadlines.

How to use this pack

1. Skim the whole pack once in 20 minutes so you know what is inside.
2. Work through one section at a time with your lecture note and recommended text beside you.
3. Attempt the practice questions before reading the answers. Mark what you missed.
4. Use the final checklist to plan your revision week, one tick per study session.

> **Free to download, always**
> This pack is free. There is no fee, no subscription and no payment step before download, and the full PDF is not watermarked or locked. Share the link with a coursemate instead of forwarding the file.

> **Confirm your official course outline**
> Course codes, credit units and outlines can differ by department and session. Treat this pack as supplementary support and confirm the current outline with your lecturer, course rep or departmental handbook before an assessment.

Organise and share

A predictable folder structure saves more time than any productivity app.

- One master folder per course or project, with subfolders for drafts, sources and final.
- Name files consistently: course, topic, version, date.
- Viewer for readers, commenter for reviewers, editor only for active contributors.
- Share the folder rather than individual files so new files inherit access.
- Use a shared calendar for deadlines and meetings.
- Remove access at the end of the project.

Collaborate without duplicates

Simultaneous editing works when you use the tools designed for it.

- Use comments for feedback and suggestions mode for edits you want reviewed.
- Do not email multiple copies; edit the single shared document.
- Use version history to see who changed what and restore an earlier state.
- Assign sections to specific people with deadlines in the document.
- Turn on offline access for documents you may need without data.
- Keep a final PDF copy for submission so formatting does not shift.

> **Final means final**
> Rename the submitted file 'FINAL' and move it out of the drafts folder. Weeks later, you will know exactly what you submitted.

Data, storage and etiquette

Cloud tools are convenient but not free of limits or risk.

- Free storage is limited; compress large images and clear old videos.
- Do not upload sensitive personal documents to shared folders.
- Check that a link is restricted before posting it publicly.
- Use two-factor authentication on the account.
- Respect bandwidth: avoid large uploads during peak hours on shared networks.
- Back up critical files locally or in a second service.

PRACTICE, NOT PREDICTION

Check your understanding

These questions are written for this pack to test the ideas above. They are not past examination questions and do not predict what your lecturer will set. Answer first, then compare.

1. What permission should reviewers have?

Answer: Commenter access, so they can give feedback without altering the document text.

2. Why share a folder instead of separate files?

Answer: New files inherit the folder's permissions, reducing missing-access problems.

3. How do you recover a deleted section in Google Docs?

Answer: Use File then Version history to view and restore an earlier version.

4. Why create a PDF before submission?

Answer: A PDF fixes the layout so formatting does not change on another device.

5. Give two cloud-storage safety practices.

Answer: Restrict link sharing and enable two-factor authentication on the account.

Your 7-step action plan

Tick each step only when you have done it. A tick you cannot defend is worse than an empty box.

- [ ] Create a course folder structure with three subfolders.
- [ ] Set correct permissions for one shared document.
- [ ] Practise commenting and suggesting changes.
- [ ] Restore an earlier version in a test document.
- [ ] Enable offline access for one folder.
- [ ] Set up a shared calendar for group deadlines.
- [ ] Export a final PDF and check formatting.

Keep going

One pack will not carry a semester. Pair this with your lecture notes, tutorials, and the past questions your department actually releases. If a topic still feels unclear, take a specific question to your lecturer or course rep - "I do not understand the difference between X and Y" gets a better answer than "I do not understand this course".

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YOUR WORKSPACE

Notes, questions and things to ask

Use this page in class or during revision. Write questions you could not answer instead of copying slides.

Three ideas I can now explain without notes:

A question I still cannot answer:

For my lecturer or course rep:

Next revision action and date:

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